



1928–2012 · James Brian Quinn, professor at Dartmouth's Tuck School.

"Own the core, rent the rest."

THE WHY THAT DROVE THE WORK

Quinn argued that firms should concentrate on the few activities where they can be best in the world and strategically outsource the rest.

INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

His work on logical incrementalism and on intelligent enterprise reframed strategy around core competencies, knowledge and selective outsourcing.

FRAMEWORKS ANCHORED IN THIS COURSE

He anchors the strategic-outsourcing reasoning behind Unit 3's make-versus-buy and sourcing Slibraries.

HOW THE IDEAS OPERATIONALISE

His ideas operationalise as the principle 'own the core, rent the rest' — retaining strategically vital capabilities and outsourcing the rest.

LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUE

Aggressive outsourcing can hollow out capability and create dependency, a risk Quinn acknowledged but that firms often underestimate.

ENDURING IMPACT

Quinn's work shaped the outsourcing and core-competence movements that define modern corporate strategy and sourcing decisions.

ON THE SAME PANEL (UNIT 3)

Nassim Nicholas Taleb · Giant 11

Cathy O'Neil · Giant 12

Andrew Ng · Giant 13

Roy Schwartz et al. · Giant 14

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Quinn, J.B. (1992) *Intelligent Enterprise*. New York: Free Press.

Quinn, J.B. and Hilmer, F.G. (1994) 'Strategic outsourcing', *Sloan Management Review*, 35(4).